

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 36)

Page 177 - Chronology of the Age of Johnson (Cont.)

Q1. In what year was Goldsmith's 'The Vicar of Wakefield' published?

- A. 1764
- B. 1766
- C. 1770
- D. 1773

Answer: B

Q2. Which poem by Oliver Goldsmith was published in 1770?

- A. The Traveller
- B. The Deserted Village
- C. The Good-natured Man
- D. The Minstrel

Answer: B

Q3. Who was born in 1770, the same year Chatterton died?

- A. William Wordsworth
- B. Samuel Taylor Coleridge
- C. Walter Scott
- D. Robert Southey

Answer: A

Q4. When was Tobias Smollett's 'Humphry Clinker' published?

- A. 1766
- B. 1768
- C. 1771
- D. 1775

Answer: C

Q5. Which future famous novelist was born in 1771, the same year Gray and Smollett died?

- A. Jane Austen
- B. Walter Scott

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C. Maria Edgeworth

D. Charles Dickens

Answer: B

Q6. Who wrote the plays 'The Rivals' (1775) and 'The School for Scandal' (1777)?

A. Oliver Goldsmith

B. Richard Brinsley Sheridan

C. Henry Fielding

D. Samuel Foote

Answer: B

Q7. In what year was Fanny Burney's 'Evelina' published?

A. 1774

B. 1776

C. 1778

D. 1783

Answer: C

Q8. Between 1776 and 1788, which monumental historical work by Gibbon was published?

A. History of England

B. Decline and Fall of the Roman Empire

C. History of the World

D. The French Revolution

Answer: B

Q9. Which two speeches on America did Edmund Burke deliver in 1774 and 1775?

A. American Taxation and Conciliation with America

B. The Rights of Man and Common Sense

C. American Independence and The Boston Tea Party

D. The Wealth of Nations and The Stamp Act

Answer: A

Q10. Who was born in 1772?

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- A. Wordsworth
- B. Southey
- C. Coleridge
- D. Byron

Answer: C

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Page 178 - Chronology to the Lyrical Ballads

Q1. In what year were William Blake's 'Poetical Sketches' published?

- A. 1783
- B. 1786
- C. 1789
- D. 1794

Answer: A

Q2. What year marks the death of Samuel Johnson?

- A. 1779
- B. 1781
- C. 1784
- D. 1791

Answer: C

Q3. In what year were Robert Burns's first poems published?

- A. 1783
- B. 1786
- C. 1789
- D. 1792

Answer: B

Q4. Which famous poet was born in 1788?

- A. Percy Bysshe Shelley
- B. John Keats
- C. Lord Byron
- D. John Clare

Answer: C

Q5. Edmund Burke published 'Reflections on the Revolution in France' in which year?

- A. 1789
- B. 1790

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C. 1792

D. 1794

Answer: B

Q6. Who wrote 'The Rights of Man' (1791-92)?

A. William Godwin

B. Thomas Paine

C. Edmund Burke

D. Jean-Jacques Rousseau

Answer: B

Q7. When was James Boswell's 'Life of Johnson' published?

A. 1784

B. 1788

C. 1791

D. 1795

Answer: C

Q8. Who wrote 'Political Justice' (1793) and 'Caleb Williams' (1794)?

A. Thomas Paine

B. William Godwin

C. Matthew Lewis

D. Ann Radcliffe

Answer: B

Q9. Matthew Lewis's Gothic novel 'The Monk' was published in:

A. 1791

B. 1793

C. 1795

D. 1798

Answer: C

Q10. What landmark publication occurred in 1798?

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- A. Blake's Songs of Experience
- B. Wordsworth and Coleridge's Lyrical Ballads
- C. Cowper's The Task
- D. Burns's Poems, Chiefly in the Scottish Dialect

Answer: B

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Page 179 - The Age of Wordsworth

Q1. The Age of Wordsworth covers approximately which years?

- A. 1740-1798
- B. 1798-1832
- C. 1832-1850
- D. 1789-1815

Answer: B

Q2. The Age of Wordsworth is characterized by the triumph of which two movements in literature?

- A. Classicism and Rationalism
- B. Romanticism and Naturalism
- C. Realism and Naturalism
- D. Modernism and Symbolism

Answer: B

Q3. The movement in literature was one aspect of a general movement, another aspect of which was:

- A. The Industrial Revolution
- B. The Protestant Reformation
- C. The political Revolution
- D. The Renaissance

Answer: C

Q4. At bottom, both the political and literary movements were inspired by an impatience of:

- A. Freedom and individuality
- B. Formulas, traditions, and the tyranny of the dead hand
- C. Economic inequalities
- D. Technological progress

Answer: B

Q5. In the new poetry and revolutionary theories, what principle was everywhere thrust to the front?

- A. Obedience to authority
- B. Adherence to classical rules

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- C. The principle of spontaneity
- D. The divine right of kings

Answer: C

Q6. How were the long-accepted rules of art treated by the new movement?

- A. With open contempt
- B. With deep reverence
- C. They were strictly enforced
- D. They were gradually updated

Answer: A

Q7. The reaction against which school of poetry became aggressive?

- A. The Metaphysical school
- B. The Elizabethan school
- C. Pope and the Augustan school
- D. The Pre-Raphaelites

Answer: C

Q8. Who wrote in the Edinburgh Review that poetry's standards 'were fixed long ago by certain inspired writers'?

- A. William Wordsworth
- B. Lord Jeffrey
- C. Samuel Taylor Coleridge
- D. John Keats

Answer: B

Q9. Did Lord Jeffrey's conservative conception represent the dominant spirit of the age?

- A. Yes, it was universally accepted
- B. No, it did not represent the dominant spirit
- C. It represented the youth but not the older generation
- D. It was the main principle of Romanticism

Answer: B

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Q10. What did the revolutionary theorists and poets both crave?

- A. Freedom and the larger life
- B. Structure and discipline
- C. Wealth and empire
- D. Scientific rationalism

Answer: A

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Page 180 - Revolutionary Ideals and Literature

Q1. Who wrote: 'The genius of poetry must work out its own salvation in a man. It cannot be matured by law and precept'?

- A. Alexander Pope
- B. John Keats
- C. William Wordsworth
- D. Lord Jeffrey

Answer: B

Q2. Who wrote the couplet: 'Those rules of old discovered, not devis'd, / Are Nature still, but Nature methodis'd'?

- A. Alexander Pope
- B. John Keats
- C. Walter Scott
- D. Lord Byron

Answer: A

Q3. The comparison of Keats's quote with Pope's couplet illustrates the fundamental difference between:

- A. Drama and poetry
- B. Augustan and romantic poetry
- C. Epic and lyric poetry
- D. Prose and verse

Answer: B

Q4. Did a person have to support the political revolution to be a romanticist?

- A. Yes, the two were inseparable
- B. No, as proven by the case of Walter Scott
- C. Only in France, not in England
- D. Yes, all romanticists were radical revolutionaries

Answer: B

Q5. Walter Scott was a romanticist, yet in politics he was a:

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- A. Whig
- B. Radical Republican
- C. Tory
- D. Jacobin

Answer: C

Q6. The vital connection between the political and literary movements is denoted by the fact that the keynote of both was:

- A. Emancipation
- B. Obedience
- C. Rationalism
- D. Melancholy

Answer: A

Q7. The great outburst of the French Revolution in 1789 was seen at first as:

- A. A terrible disaster for humanity
- B. A military threat to England
- C. The prophecy of a new day and democratic ideals
- D. The end of European civilization

Answer: C

Q8. Ardent young souls were kindled with wonderful enthusiasm and gorgeous dreams of:

- A. Conquest and power
- B. Progress and perfection
- C. Wealth and aristocracy
- D. Industrial capitalism

Answer: B

Q9. Why were men in England ready to catch fire by contact with the passions the French cause aroused?

- A. Because they wanted to conquer France
- B. Because there had been a steady growth in England of the principles the revolution promised
- C. Because England was officially allied with the French revolutionaries
- D. Because they hated the British monarchy

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Answer: B

Q10. The French Revolution promised to translate abstractions into:

- A. Poetic verses
- B. Living facts
- C. Classical drama
- D. Religious dogma

Answer: B

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Page 181 - Disillusionment and Wordsworth's Youth

Q1. Who wrote: 'Bliss was it in that dawn to be alive, / But to be young was very heaven'?

- A. Samuel Taylor Coleridge
- B. Lord Byron
- C. William Wordsworth
- D. Percy Bysshe Shelley

Answer: C

Q2. The glorious promises of 1789 were eventually:

- A. Fully realized across Europe
- B. Destined to remain unfulfilled
- C. Accepted by the crowned heads of Europe
- D. Forgotten by the romantic poets immediately

Answer: B

Q3. Which of the following contributed to the general collapse of faith and hope?

- A. The Reign of Terror
- B. The establishment of a military despotism under Napoleon
- C. The restoration of the Bourbons
- D. All of the above

Answer: D

Q4. Following the failure of the great effort initiated by France, what replaced the age of buoyancy and expectation?

- A. An age of permanent peace
- B. An age of unrest and disillusion
- C. An age of classical revival
- D. An age of absolute monarchy

Answer: B

Q5. When was William Wordsworth born?

- A. 1770

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B. 1789

C. 1798

D. 1800

Answer: A

Q6. Where was William Wordsworth born?

A. London

B. Edinburgh, Scotland

C. Cockermouth, Cumberland

D. Bristol

Answer: C

Q7. Among whom did Wordsworth spend much of his boyhood?

A. Aristocrats and politicians

B. Shepherds and dalesmen

C. Factory workers

D. Sailors and merchants

Answer: B

Q8. What did Wordsworth learn from his familiar intercourse with simple peasant folk?

A. The art of sophisticated conversation

B. Faith in humanity and reverence for the elemental things of life

C. To despise manual labor

D. Strict Calvinist theology

Answer: B

Q9. Where was Wordsworth educated before going to Cambridge?

A. Eton College

B. Westminster School

C. Hawkeshead School, Lancashire

D. Rugby School

Answer: C

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Q10. In what years did Wordsworth make his two visits to France?

- A. 1785 and 1788
- B. 1790 and 1791-92
- C. 1795 and 1797
- D. 1800 and 1802

Answer: B